

# Parliament must act to ensure Australia never has 'secret ministers' again

August 17, 2022



It was revealed this week that former prime minister Scott Morrison was secretly [appointed](#) in 2020 and 2021 by Governor-General David Hurley as a minister in the health, finance, treasury, resources and home affairs portfolios.

The cabinet didn't know, the parliament didn't know, and the public didn't know about these appointments. So far, it appears Morrison only exercised his secret ministerial powers in the resources portfolio.



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centre/government/instruments-scott-morrison-2020-21">appointed</a> in 2020 and 2021 by Governor-General David Hurley as a minister in the health, finance, treasury, resources and home affairs portfolios.</p><p>The cabinet didn't know, the parliament didn't know, and the public didn't know about these appointments. So far, it appears Morrison only exercised his secret ministerial powers in the resources portfolio.</p><hr><p><strong><em>Read more: </em></strong><a href="https://theconversation.com/scott-morrison-made-himself-treasurer-days-before-the-2021-budget-188808"><strong><em>Scott Morrison made himself treasurer days before the 2021 budget</em></strong></a></p><hr><p>The situation has been described in various ways, including as "the sort of tin-pot activity that we would ridicule if it was in a non-democratic country" by Prime Minister <a href="https://www.theguardian.com/australia-news/2022/aug/15/anthony-albanese-seeks-legal-advice-over-reports-scott-morrison-secretly-swore-himself-into-ministry-roles">Anthony Albanese</a>: "sinister" by former

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